



FIELD GUIDE • 5 WORKFLOWS

5 AI Office Workflows for Faster Paperwork, Cleaner Handoffs, and Better Staff Output

Practical ways service and trade offices can use AI with job notes, estimates, spreadsheets, project updates, emails, photos, exports, and staff knowledge — without replacing the software they already use.

Your software stores the pieces of the work. Your office still has to turn those pieces into numbers, paperwork, updates, and decisions. **These five workflows show exactly where AI earns its keep.**

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Most AI tips are too generic for real service-business office work.

"Use AI to summarize this." "Use AI to rewrite that." Fine for a student — useless for an office that has to turn scattered field information into clean paperwork, correct billing, and a handoff the next person can act on.

The work that actually eats your day isn't one short note. It's combining a dozen messy sources into a packet. Cross-reading an estimate against an invoice. Triaging an 80-row export. Extracting the truth from a buried thread. Capturing what your best employee knows. That's where time goes, and that's what these workflows target.

One rule sets the boundary: if your software already handles a step cleanly, leave it there. Use AI where work still lives across notes, photos, spreadsheets, exports, emails, texts, project logs, and someone's memory.

Cleaner paperwork. Better handoffs. Faster billing. **The same office team.**

First

Five moves that separate casual AI use from output you can actually send.

Every prompt in this guide already uses these. Learn them once and you'll get more out of any AI tool, on any task — not just the five workflows that follow.

Move 01

Give it a role first

Start with "You are an office manager at an HVAC company." The same request answered "as an office manager" comes back sharper than answered as nobody. One sentence, big difference.

Move 02

Feed it your real stuff

Paste your actual estimate format, a job packet that was done right, or an export you work from. AI copies the example you give it — so give it yours instead of letting it invent a generic one.

Move 03

Tell it the output shape

Ask for a numbered list, a table, or a labeled packet. "Summarize this" wanders; "give me a clean internal summary, a missing-info list, and a billing verdict" gives you something usable as-is.

Move 04

Give it "do not" rules

Do not invent prices. Do not guess approvals. Separate facts from assumptions. The limits matter more than the request — they're what keep a confident wrong answer off an invoice or out of a customer's inbox.

Move 05

Keep a prompt library

The moment a prompt gives you great output, save it in one shared doc with a plain name — "job packet builder," "estimate-vs-invoice check." That's the whole game: a casual user retypes prompts; a sharp office reuses the handful that work, and the whole team produces at the same level. Every prompt in this guide is built to live in that doc.

01-05

Five AI Office Workflows.

Each is a real piece of office work — assembly, quality control, triage, extraction, standardization. Every one comes with what to gather, a full copy/paste prompt with anti-hallucination rules, a realistic output, a staff review rule, and how to make it yours.

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|----|---|-----------------|
| 01 | Turn scattered job info into an office-ready work packet | ASSEMBLY |
| 02 | Catch estimate-to-invoice mismatches before they cost you | QUALITY CONTROL |
| 03 | Turn ugly exports into a ranked office action list | TRIAGE |
| 04 | Turn messy threads into clean office actions | EXTRACTION |
| 05 | Turn your best employee's process into a reusable office playbook | STANDARDIZE |
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Workflow 01

Turn scattered job info into an office-ready work packet

ASSEMBLY

THE OFFICE PROBLEM The information exists — it's just scattered. Notes in one place, photos in another, the customer's request in an email, the tech's update by text, the estimate in the software, a private note someone scribbled. Before anything can move, a person has to gather all of it and turn it into one clean next step. That assembly is invisible work, and it happens from scratch every time.

WHAT TO GATHER

job / project notes

photos or descriptions

customer request

field update

estimate / scope

internal notes

material & labor notes

scheduling constraints

billing status

THE WORKFLOW

Drop every piece you have into one prompt — messy and out of order is fine. AI assembles it into a structured packet that separates what's **confirmed** from what's **assumed**, and flags anything that touches money, scheduling, or a customer promise for human review.

COPY / PASTE PROMPT

job-packet-builder.txt

COPY & PASTE

Inputs I am giving you (some may be messy or out of order):

1. Job / project notes
2. Photos or photo descriptions
3. Customer request
4. Technician / field update
5. Estimate or scope
6. Internal notes, material/labor notes, scheduling, billing status

Your job:

Combine these into one office-ready work packet for a [trade] business.

Return, with clear headers:

1. INTERNAL SUMMARY — clean, factual, full sentences.
2. CUSTOMER-SAFE SUMMARY — friendly, no pricing, no jargon.
3. MISSING INFORMATION — what's needed before this moves.
4. NEXT OFFICE ACTION — the single next step.
5. SCHEDULING / BILLING IMPLICATIONS.
6. RISKS OR CONFLICTS — including sources that disagree.
7. NEEDS REVIEW — anything a human must approve.

Rules:

- Do not invent facts, prices, measurements, approvals, dates, or promises.
- Separate confirmed facts from assumptions. Label assumptions.
- If two sources conflict, show both and flag it.
- If output affects money, scheduling, customer promises, safety, warranty, or legal language, mark it REVIEW.

[paste all sources below]

RETURNED PACKET (ABBREVIATED)

- 01

Internal summary

— Rooftop unit replaced; condensate line rerouted. Tech notes thermostat "acting up" — not diagnosed.
- 02

Customer-safe

— Your new unit is installed and running. We're following up on the thermostat behavior you mentioned.
- 03

Missing info

— No photo of completed line; no model # for the thermostat.
- 04

Conflict

— Estimate lists 1 return; field note says 2 installed.

REVIEW
- 05

Needs review

— Second return affects billing. Confirm before invoicing.

MAKE IT YOURS

Paste in **one packet your office built well** and add: "Match this structure and level of detail." Add your real review rules — e.g. "Always REVIEW anything over \$X or any warranty claim." The packet now comes back in your house format, not a generic one.

STAFF REVIEW RULE

Anything marked **REVIEW** or sitting under a **conflict** is the human's job before the packet is used. The workflow's value is that it **surfaces** the conflict between estimate and field notes — not that it resolves it. A person makes the call on money, scope, and promises.

Workflow 02

Catch estimate-to-invoice mismatches before they cost you

QUALITY CONTROL

THE OFFICE PROBLEM The estimate said one thing. The field added two things. A change order may or may not have been approved. The invoice draft might miss completed work, or bill for work that got cut. Every one of these is a delayed payment, a dispute, or money left on the table — and catching it means someone manually cross-reading four documents that don't line up. Most offices skip that read under pressure and eat the difference.

WHAT TO GATHER

THE WORKFLOW

AI does the cross-read you don't have time for: it lines the estimate up against what actually happened in the field and against the invoice draft, then tells you where money is at risk — in **both** directions — before anything goes out.

COPY / PASTE PROMPT

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estimate-invoice-check.txt
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COPY & PASTE

Inputs I am giving you:

1. Approved estimate
2. Field notes / daily logs
3. Change orders or add-ons
4. Material / PO and labor notes
5. Invoice or billing draft
6. Previous billing status

Your job:

Act as a billing quality-control reviewer for a [trade] business. Compare these documents before we send the invoice.

Return:

1. WHAT MATCHES — estimate, field, and invoice agree.
2. WHAT DOES NOT MATCH — line by line.
3. MISSING APPROVAL OR PROOF — e.g. unapproved change order.
4. POSSIBLE UNDERBILLING — completed work not on the invoice.
5. OVERBILLING / DISPUTE RISK — billed but not clearly proven.
6. QUESTIONS TO RESOLVE before sending.
7. BILLING RECOMMENDATION: READY / REVIEW / BLOCKED, with reason.

Rules:

- Do not invent prices, quantities, approvals, or dates.
- If a document is missing, say so — do not assume.
- Separate confirmed facts from assumptions.
- Flag anything affecting money or approvals as REVIEW.

[paste all documents below]

WHAT GOOD OUTPUT LOOKS LIKE

RETURNED REVIEW (ABBREVIATED)

- 01 **Underbilling** — Field logs show a second service call (4/12) not on the invoice. Likely missed revenue.
- 02 **Dispute risk** — Invoice bills 6 hrs labor; labor notes support 4. No note for the extra 2.
- 03 **Missing approval** — Add-on damper (\$420) in field notes; no signed change order found.
- 04 **Resolve first** — Confirm the 4/12 visit is billable; get damper approval in writing.
- 05 **Recommendation** — REVIEW Two items need confirmation before sending.

MAKE IT YOURS

Add your **billing rules** to the prompt: minimum documentation for a change order, what counts as proof of completion, your labor-rounding policy. The reviewer then enforces **your** standard, and the READY / REVIEW / BLOCKED verdict means something specific to your shop.

STAFF REVIEW RULE

Treat the output as a **flag list, not a ruling**. A "possible underbilling" is a prompt to go check the field log, not permission to add a line. Never let the tool change an invoice amount on its own — it points; a person decides and documents why.

Workflow 03

Turn ugly exports into a ranked office action list

TRIAGE

THE OFFICE PROBLEM The data isn't the problem — you have plenty. AR aging, stale estimates, completed-not-billed, open change orders, jobs with no recent update. It's sitting in a CSV, a Smartsheet, an accounting export. The hard part is staring at 80 rows and deciding what the office should actually **do first**, who owns each one, and what can wait. So it doesn't get decided, and the list rots.

WHAT TO GATHER

exported rows / pasted table

job / customer name

status

amount or value

due date / age

last update

owner

notes / blockers

THE WORKFLOW

Paste the raw export — columns and all. AI ranks it into what to act on now, what to group, what to chase, and what to escalate, with a concrete next action per row and a flag on anything where the data itself looks incomplete.

COPY / PASTE PROMPT

export-to-actionlist.txt

COPY & PASTE

Inputs I am giving you:

A raw export (pasted rows or a table) of [e.g. open AR / stale estimates / completed-not-billed] from our [system]. Columns may include name, status, amount, age, last update, owner, and notes.

Your job:

Turn this into a ranked office action list for a [trade] business. Decide what we do next, not just what the data says.

Return:

1. TOP PRIORITY – act this week, with the reason each ranks high.
2. GROUPED CATEGORIES – cluster similar items.
3. NEXT ACTION per row – concrete and specific.
4. WHO HANDLES IT – admin, manager, or owner.
5. CAN WAIT – with a revisit date.
6. ESCALATE – needs owner attention now.
7. MISSING FIELDS / NEEDS VERIFICATION – rows where the data is incomplete or looks wrong.

Rules:

- Do not invent amounts, dates, or statuses not in the data.
- If a row is too incomplete to rank, list it under NEEDS VERIFICATION instead of guessing.
- Prioritize by value at risk and age, not row order.

[paste the export below]

WHAT GOOD OUTPUT LOOKS LIKE

MESSY EXPORT IN

Hartwell – invoiced – \$8,400 – 72 days – "left VM 2x" | Boyd reno – est sent – \$15,200 – 19 days – (blank) | Unit 4C – completed – (blank) – 31 days – "ready?"

RANKED LIST OUT

- 01 **Top priority** — Hartwell \$8.4k, 72 days past due, two ignored VMs → manager calls today, then a formal notice.
- 02 **Escalate** — Unit 4C marked completed 31 days, no amount → likely completed-not-billed. Owner confirms scope.
- 03 **Can wait** — Boyd estimate, 19 days, still in window → follow-up message Thursday.
- 04 **Needs verification** — Unit 4C has no value; pull the job record before billing.

MAKE IT YOURS

Tell it your **thresholds**: "Anything over 60 days or \$5,000 is top priority," "estimates are stale after 14 days." Name your people so "who handles it" returns real names. Now the same export produces a list that already matches how your office triages.

STAFF REVIEW RULE

Check the **Needs Verification** section first — those are rows where the export was incomplete, and acting on them blind is how a customer gets dunned for an already-paid invoice. The ranking is a starting order, not a command to send anything.

Workflow 04 Turn messy threads into clean office actions

EXTRACTION

THE OFFICE PROBLEM The real instructions are buried in a 40-message thread. A scope change three replies deep. A vendor delay mentioned in passing. A GC approval that's implied but never confirmed. A payment note nobody logged. Whoever picks up the job has to scroll the whole thing and reconstruct what's actually true now — and if they miss one line, the office acts on stale information. This isn't about writing a nicer reply. It's about extracting what changed and what to do.

WHAT TO GATHER

full email / text thread

job / project context

current status

relevant rules or constraints

deadlines / payment / scheduling info

THE WORKFLOW

Paste the entire thread. AI reads it as an operator, not a writer — pulling out what actually changed, who owns the next move, what to update in the system, and what's still unconfirmed, plus a ready reply only if one is needed.

COPY / PASTE PROMPT

thread-to-actions.txt

COPY & PASTE

Inputs I am giving you:

1. A full email / text / project thread
2. The job or project context and current status
3. Any company rules, deadlines, or payment/scheduling info

Your job:

Read this thread as an office coordinator for a [trade] business and extract what the office must actually do. This is about operational truth, not writing a nicer message.

Return:

1. WHAT CHANGED – decisions, scope, schedule, money, approvals.
2. REQUIRED NEXT ACTION – specific.
3. WHO OWNS IT.
4. WHAT TO UPDATE IN THE SYSTEM – fields/records to change.
5. REPLY DRAFT – only if a customer/vendor reply is needed.
6. INTERNAL JOB NOTE – short, factual, for the record.
7. MISSING CONTEXT – what's implied but not confirmed.
8. RISK IF IGNORED – what breaks if this sits.

Rules:

- Do not invent agreements, prices, dates, or approvals.
- If something is implied but not confirmed, put it under MISSING CONTEXT – do not treat it as decided.
- Quote the thread line when a change hinges on it.

[paste the thread below]

WHAT GOOD OUTPUT LOOKS LIKE

RETURNED ACTIONS (ABBREVIATED)

01 **What changed** — Customer moved the install to the 22nd and added a second zone (msg 9).

02 **Next action** — Reschedule crew; issue change order for zone 2 before work.

03 **Update system** — Job date → 4/22; add zone-2 line; status → awaiting CO signature.

04 **Missing context** — Customer says "the GC approved it" — no approval in thread. Confirm.

REVIEW

05 **Risk if ignored** — Crew shows on the old date; zone 2 done without a signed CO.

MAKE IT YOURS

Add your rules: "No added scope without a signed change order," "GC verbal approvals don't count." The extraction then flags violations against **your** policy automatically — turning a buried thread into a compliance check, not just a summary.

STAFF REVIEW RULE

The **Missing Context** section is the point of the whole workflow. Anything there — an implied approval, an assumed date — must be confirmed with a real person before the office acts. The reply draft never goes out untouched on anything involving money or scope.

Workflow 05

Turn your best employee's process into a reusable office playbook

STANDARDIZE

THE OFFICE PROBLEM Your best estimator, your sharpest office manager — their real skill is judgment on the messy stuff, and it lives entirely in their head. New hires get handed the software and left to guess. When that person is out, or leaves, the standard walks out with them. You don't need them to write a manual at night. You need a way to **extract** what they know into something the next person can follow.

WHAT TO GATHER

examples of good work

examples of bad / messy work

the expert's explanation

company rules

common mistakes

tools used

role responsibilities

THE WORKFLOW

Record or type the experienced person talking through how they do it — rough is fine — and paste in a good example and a bad one. AI turns that into a real SOP, a checklist, a good-vs-bad guide, and a role-specific prompt the next hire can actually use.

COPY / PASTE PROMPT

tribal-knowledge-to-sop.txt

COPY & PASTE

Inputs I am giving you:

1. An experienced employee's explanation of how they do
[task, e.g. prep a job for estimate] (may be rough/spoken)
2. One example of GOOD finished work
3. One example of MESSY or bad work
4. Company rules, common mistakes, and tools used
5. The role responsible

Your job:

Turn this into a reusable office playbook for a [trade] business, written for a new hire who is not yet experienced.

Return:

1. STEP-BY-STEP SOP – in plain language.
2. CHECKLIST – what must be true before it's "done."
3. GOOD VS BAD – what separates the two examples, specifically.
4. ROLE-SPECIFIC AI PROMPT – one this person can reuse weekly.
5. COMMON MISTAKES – and how to avoid each.
6. REVIEW RULES – what a manager checks before sign-off.
7. TRAINING EXERCISE – one practice task with an answer key.
8. MANAGER REVIEW RUBRIC – how to score the new hire's work.

Rules:

- Base the SOP only on what the expert actually said and the examples shown. Do not invent steps.
- Where the expert's logic is unclear, list it as an open question for them to confirm – do not fill the gap.
- Keep it specific to this task, not generic advice.

[paste the explanation and both examples below]

RETURNED PLAYBOOK (ABBREVIATED)

- 01

SOP step 3

— Before pricing, confirm access, panel location, and permit need — the expert always checks these three first.
- 02

Good vs bad

— Good estimate names the panel and access path; the messy one said "standard install" and got two change orders.
- 03

Common mistake

— Skipping the site-access question → crew arrives, can't reach the unit, day lost.
- 04

Open question

— Expert mentioned a "gut-check on weird ones" — ask them to define the trigger.

CONFIRM
- 05

Training exercise

— Price this sample job; compare against the answer key's three access checks.

MAKE IT YOURS

Do this once per role — estimator, office manager, dispatcher — and store the playbooks together. Re-run it every few months with fresh good/bad examples and the SOP stays current. This is how the same team gets more consistent without anyone writing documentation by hand.

STAFF REVIEW RULE

The expert reviews the SOP before it's used — especially every **open question / CONFIRM** flag, which is where their judgment didn't fully translate. The playbook captures the process; only the person can verify it captured it **right**.

Next

These are manual examples. The Blueprint makes them yours.

These workflows are strong on their own. Stanley Systems can turn the same idea into installed office workflows — built around the tools your team already uses.

- 2–3 workflow-specific AI staff plays for your trade
- One quick capacity win you can act on immediately
- The office work AI should take off your team first
- The best next workflow worth improving
- Staff prompts tuned to your real bottlenecks, not these general ones

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